

Michael Vargo

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PROFESSIONAL OVERVIEW

City planner and data researcher with experience in transportation planning, environmental analysis, GIS, and policy evaluation. Proficient planner, public communicator, and data analyst seeking opportunities in land use policy, transportation, and strategic planning.

WORK EXPERIENCE

- Real Estate Analyst, Jr | Novogradac & Company LLP, Columbus, OHSept 2026 – Present
 - Analysis, interviewing, and research for nationwide market studies, rent comparison studies, and site valuation, principally relating to LIHTC-financed affordable housing projects.
- Teaching Assistant | The Ohio State University, Columbus, OHJan 2026 – May 2026
 - Course design, student assessment, and in-class instruction on topics related to land use and transportation, including demand modeling, transit-oriented development, and sprawl.
- Travel Demand Modeling Intern | Ohio Dept. of Transportation, Columbus, OHMay 2025 – Dec 2025
 - Developed R tools that standardized analysis of more than 20 years of statewide travel forecast data, enabling future accuracy assessments.
 - Authored ODOT's first comprehensive report on statewide forecast accuracy in 11 years. This work detailed trends in forecast error and offered recommendations for data governance.
 - Supported FHWA research into forecast performance through testing and input on new methods to facilitate accuracy assessments by states and MPOs nationwide.
- Teaching Assistant | Académie de Strasbourg, Guebwiller, FranceOct 2022 – April 2023
 - Led course design, assessment, and in-class instruction for groups of 15 to 25 students.
 - Engaged students in English language instruction through activity-based learning, individual tutoring, interdisciplinary lessons, and cultural activities.

EDUCATION

- Master of City & Regional Planning | Knowlton School, The Ohio State University2024 – 2026
- Arabic – Intermediate-Advanced (3.5) | Middlebury Language School2022
- Bachelor of Arts in Arabic, French, Political Science | The Ohio State University2017 – 2021

RECOGNITION

- Knowlton School's Hazel Morrow Jones Award for Outstanding Graduate Student2025, 2026

SKILLS

- Document DesignAdobe InDesign, Canva, knitr, Quarto, Word
- Graphic and Web DesignAdobe Illustrator, Quarto, Github Pages, Basic HTML, CSS, and JS
- 2/3D ModelingSketchup, Rayshader
- Data AnalysisTidyverse, OLS & spatial models, Geo/Pandas, Excel
- Data Visualizationggplot2, Plotly, knitr, Shiny, Matplotlib, ArcGIS Insights
- GIS and CartographyArcGIS Pro, ESRI Suite, QGIS, R-Spatial
- ProgrammingPython, R, Github
- Stakeholder EngagementPublic speaking, stakeholder interviews
- Planning and PolicyCritical writing, policy evaluation, research, site assessment
- LanguagesEnglish, French (C1-C2), Arabic (B1), Portuguese (Reading)